SOCIOECONOMIC FALSE BELIEF #41 · GOD'S PROVISION

“If God loved me, I wouldn't be struggling.”

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Where it often comes from

When money runs short, it is natural to wonder where God is. Many of us were taught, openly or quietly, that love and ease go together: good children are cared for, and loved people are comfortable. Hardship then feels like a message about how God sees us. Add a hard childhood, a loss, or a prayer that seemed unanswered, and the conclusion “He must not love me” can feel like the only explanation.

What Scripture teaches

Scripture never ties God’s love to a smooth life. Jesus said plainly, “In the world you will have tribulation. But take courage; I have overcome the world!” Paul says that nothing in all creation can separate us from the love of God in Christ Jesus. He also teaches that suffering produces perseverance, character, and hope, and that God has poured out His love into our hearts. The cross, where struggle and love met, is the proof of His love, not the absence of struggle.

> *“For I am convinced that neither death nor life, neither angels nor principalities, neither the present nor the future, nor any powers, neither height nor depth, nor anything else in all creation, will be able to separate us from the love of God that is in Christ Jesus our Lord”* (Romans 8:38–39).

Also see

> “I have told you these things so that in Me you may have peace. In the world you will have tribulation. But take courage; I have overcome the world!” (John 16:33).

> “Not only that, but we also rejoice in our sufferings, because we know that suffering produces perseverance; perseverance, character; and character, hope. And hope does not disappoint us, because God has poured out His love into our hearts through the Holy Spirit, whom He has given us” (Romans 5:3–5).

> “But God proves His love for us in this: While we were still sinners, Christ died for us” (Romans 5:8).

> “Consider it pure joy, my brothers, when you encounter trials of many kinds, because you know that the testing of your faith develops perseverance” (James 1:2–3).

Common self-statements

- God must be angry with me.
- Other people are not struggling like this, so God must love them more.
- If God cared, He would fix this.
- Maybe God does not love me the way He loves others.
- I must have done something to lose His love.
- My hardship proves I am not loved.

Common logical errors

- Emotional reasoning: Feeling unloved and concluding that I am.
- Mind reading: Assuming I know how God feels about me from my circumstances.
- Overgeneralizing: Letting one hard season define God’s whole character.
- Social comparison: Believing others are loved more because they struggle less.

Challenging questions

- What did I learn growing up about the link between love and comfort?
- Did Jesus, whom the Father loved, go through hardship? What does that tell me?
- What does Scripture say can separate me from God's love?
- Where have I seen God's care even in this hard season?
- What evidence of God's love do I have that does not depend on my bank account?
- What would I say to a friend who believed this?

Truth summary

> God's love for me is proven by Christ's death for me, not by my circumstances. I can struggle and be deeply loved at the same time. Nothing, including a hard season with money, can separate me from His love.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- God, All Loving
- Love, By God
- Hardship
- Suffering
- Troubles

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Suffering
- Trouble/Hardship

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

The God Who Stays — Matthew West
God's faithful presence challenges the expectation of rejection and abandonment.

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

He Knows — Jeremy Camp
Jesus understands suffering and invites people to bring their burdens to Him.

Jesus Loves Me — Gaither Vocal Band
This familiar hymn places confidence in Jesus' love rather than personal strength.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "If God loved me, I wouldn't be struggling"

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"If God loved me, I wouldn't be struggling." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What did I learn about love and comfort?
- ☐ What does Romans 8 say can separate me from God's love?
- ☐ Where has God cared for me lately?
- ☐ What did Jesus' own life show about love and struggle?
- ☐ What would I tell a friend?
- ☐ What do I need to tell God honestly?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ God's love is not measured by my comfort.
- ☐ Nothing can separate me from His love.
- ☐ Christ proved His love while I was still a sinner.
- ☐ Hardship can grow perseverance, character, and hope.
- ☐ Jesus overcame the world.
- ☐ I am loved in the middle of this.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ **Romans 8:38–39**
  "For I am convinced that neither death nor life, neither angels nor principalities, neither the present nor the future, nor any powers, neither height nor depth, nor anything else in all creation, will be able to separate us from the love of God that is in Christ Jesus our Lord."
- ☐ **John 16:33**
  "I have told you these things so that in Me you may have peace. In the world you will have tribulation. But take courage; I have overcome the world!"
- ☐ **Romans 5:8**
  "But God proves His love for us in this: While we were still sinners, Christ died for us."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Signs of His love: Each day, write one sign of God's love that has nothing to do with money, such as a person, a verse, or a moment of peace.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Romans 8:38–39 becomes: "Sarah can write: "Nothing can separate me from God's love, even this hard season.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "God, All Loving" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

This card is educational and is not financial or legal advice. Choose steps you can do safely. If you are without food, housing, or safety, contact your church, a trusted advisor, or local assistance services.

- [ ] Write the link you were taught. Describe what you learned about love and comfort and who taught it.
- [ ] Read Romans 8:35–39 slowly. Underline each thing that cannot separate you from God's love.
- [ ] List signs of care. Write five ways God has cared for you in this season.
- [ ] Tell God honestly. Pray what you feel, including the hurt, and then ask Him to show His love.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "If God loved me, I wouldn't be struggling": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	A sign of His love
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~If God loved me, I wouldn't be struggling.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Father, this season is hard and I have wondered whether You love me. Show me again that nothing can separate me from Your love in Christ. Hold me in this, and open my eyes to Your care. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.